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Jobless Rates At Record Levels

RACISM CAUSES SHARP INCREASE IN BLACK UNEMPLOYMENT—40.4% FOR TEENS



Due to an upsurge in racial bias, Black unemployment, especially for Black youth, is rapidly increasing at alarming rates. According to recent statistics the jobless rate for Black teenagers (16-19 years of age) is 40.4 per cent. In New York the figure approaches 90 per cent for Black youth, while the overall rate for Blacks is 14.5 per cent — equaling post-WWII record levels.

(Washington, D.C.) — Labor Department statistics released last week indicate an upsurge of racism and racial discrimination in hiring have caused a sharp increase in Black unemployment throughout the United States, with bleak prospects for a reversal in the current trends.

With the national jobless rate showing a slight rise from 6.4 per cent in July to 7.1 per cent in August, even the Labor Department admitted the increase in unemployment to 6.9 million without jobs "was concentrated among Black workers."

According to statistics released last week:

- Jobless rates for Black teenagers, aged 16 to 19 years old was 40.4 per cent;
- For Black youth 16 to 21, joblessness is at an all-time summer high of 34.8 per cent, an incredible increase from the 30.0 per cent figure in 1976;
- Jobless rates for Black men were up from 10.1 per cent in July to 11.7 per cent in August;
- Jobless rates for Black women were up from 10.9 per cent in July to 12.2 per cent in August;
- Overall, the unemployment rate for the Black community skyrocketed from 13.2 per cent in July to 14.5 per cent in August, matching a post-World War II record set during the depths of the recession in September, 1975.

In other words, the U.S. has made absolutely no headway in solving the critical, overriding crisis in Black unemployment in the past 23 months!

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